

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣ K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ 8

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3 ♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠ 4

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣ J

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8
 ♥ J 10 9
 ♦ A 10 3
 ♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q J 5 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ J 8 6



♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ A 7

♠ 7 2

♥ 8 6 5 3 2

♦ J 8 7

♣ K Q 9

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♣K			

NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣. It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠.

NORTH cannot bid game yet, after all, SOUTH could have as few as 6 points. But she can continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that SOUTH actually has 9 or 10 points.

SOUTH comes through with 4 ♠.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 2
♥ Q 9 6 4
♦ K 6 2
♣ A Q 3

♠ A 5 4 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 3

♣ J 10 6 4



♠ K J 6

♥ K J 8 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ 8 5

♠ Q 10 9

♥ 10 3

♦ Q 9 8 5

♣ K 9 7 2

EAST has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1♥.

WEST has 11 points and good ♥ support so she jumps to 3♥.

EAST knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by East

Lead: ♦8

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 3
♦ Q J 5 4 2
♣ K 6 2

♠ Q J

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ Q J 7



♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 9 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A K Q 7 2

♦ K 6

♣ 10 9 5

NORTH has 11 points and she should pass.

SOUTH has a minimum 1♥ opening, 13 points and five trumps.

NORTH, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3♥.
(This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but SOUTH can add and he knows the total points will be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3♥.

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by South			
Lead: ♦Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 10 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

♠ 4

♥ 10 6 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ K Q 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 8 3

♣ 10 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ J 9 8

♦ A K 6 2

♣ J 8 3

West

1 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by West

Lead: ♠4

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

WEST has a normal 1 ♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

EAST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2 ♠.

WEST passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. EAST can have a maximum of 10 points, which would only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10

♥ 10 9 6 4

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4



♠ 9 8

♥ A 7 3 2

♦ Q J 4

♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points NORTH should open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

NORTH adds: her 16 plus SOUTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣J

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6



♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

♠ 9 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4 3

♣ 7 4 2

EAST has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal EAST will open 1♠.

WEST has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

EAST adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

3♠

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♦Q